THE COMMS BOARD ROOM

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TECH & COMMS · SPEAKER CONCEPT NOTE · TOPIC 03

Building a Personal Brand (Before You Think You're "Ready")

Where Communications Meet Technology

Onaopemipo Famori SPEAKER

DATE	Thursday, 26 November 2026
VENUE	Legacy Hall, Crawford University
YOUR ROLE	Speaker
YOUR SESSION	Building a Personal Brand (Before You Think You're "Ready")
LENGTH	20 minutes; questions from students come in the open Q&A at the end
AUDIENCE	Mass Communication students (all levels), with lecturers and alumni
FORMAT	Three 20-minute talks, a panel, then an open Q&A in the hall
PARTNERS	Department of Mass Communication, Crawford University, and the Crawford University Alumni Association

01 About Tech & Comms

Tech & Comms is an initiative of The Comms Boardroom (TCBR) to close the gap between what students are taught about communications and what the profession looks like on the ground. It is not a lecture series. It is a set of honest conversations, led by people currently doing the work, built around three things every Mass Communication student deserves to hear before they graduate: communications in the real world, media intelligence and proving value, and building a personal brand.

02 Why this session matters

A lot of students wait until after graduation to start building anything online, because they assume personal branding through storytelling and content creation is only for people who already have a success story to tell. We push back on that.

Personal branding isn't about having arrived somewhere. It's about being willing to document the process of getting there. The story worth telling isn't "I made it." It's "here's who I'm becoming." This

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session walks students through that mindset, plus the practical basics of getting their profiles in order.

03 What we would love you to cover

- The mindset shift: from "I have nothing to show yet" to documenting the journey.
- Storytelling for a personal brand: finding your angle, your interests and your voice.
- Content basics: what to post as a student (class projects, events, lessons learned, opinions on industry news) and how often.
- Getting profiles in order: photo, headline, about section, featured work and links, especially on LinkedIn.
- Consistency, networking and the mistakes to avoid.

04 Suggested flow

1	**Open**	Your own story, including the early, unpolished part.
2	**The mindset**	"Here's who I'm becoming" and why starting now matters.
3	**Story and content**	Simple ideas students can post this month.
4	**Profile clinic**	A quick before-and-after of a student profile (with permission) or a live headline rewrite.
5	**Close**	A one-week challenge students can start tonight.

A suggestion only. Shape it around your own stories.

05 What students should leave with

> - You don't need a success story to start; you need a direction and the willingness to show the process.
> - A clear photo, headline and about section already put a student ahead of most.
> - Consistency matters more than polish.

06 Questions students may ask you

- What should I post if I haven't done anything big yet?
- Should I keep my personal and professional accounts separate?
- How do I handle negative comments or people I know watching?
- How do recruiters actually use LinkedIn?

07 Tone and approach

- Speak from your own work. Real examples, real numbers where you can share them, and real mistakes land better than definitions.
- Keep it Nigerian. Show how the work looks here, not only how the textbooks describe it.
- Talk with the students, not at them. Short stories, plain language, and room for questions.
- Leave them with something to do this week, not only something to think about.

08 What we need from you

- A short bio (60–80 words) and a clear headshot, for the programme and our social posts.
- Slides are optional. If you use them, please send them a day before so we can load them on the hall system.
- Your preferred social handles, so we can tag you when we share highlights.
- Any equipment you need (for example, internet access for a live demo).

Thank you for giving your time to the next generation of communicators.

Samuel Ogundeji
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